BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #34 · BRAIN INJURY AND MEMORY

“If I forget things, people will think less of me.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Embarrassment about missing names, repeating stories, or losing track of the conversation can lead to avoiding gatherings or hiding the problem.

What Scripture teaches

“Man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.” “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ.” “The parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable.” True friends value you more than your memory. Being honest about your difficulty often brings understanding and help, and makes it easier to enjoy company. God never forgets you: “I have inscribed you on the palms of My hands.”

> *“But the LORD said to Samuel, ‘Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.’”* (1 Samuel 16:7).

Also see

> “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ” (Galatians 6:2).

> “On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable” (1 Corinthians 12:22).

> “Behold, I have inscribed you on the palms of My hands; your walls are ever before Me” (Isaiah 49:16).

> “Therefore, as the elect of God, holy and beloved, clothe yourselves with hearts of compassion, kindness, humility, gentleness, and patience” (Colossians 3:12).

Common self-statements

- They will think I am senile.
- I am embarrassing.
- I have to hide it.
- I will lose respect.
- I should stay home.
- They are judging me.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing people either respect me or think less of me.
- Fortune telling: Predicting disrespect.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling embarrassed and concluding I am judged.
- Mind reading: Calling myself an embarrassment.

Challenging questions

- What do my close friends say when I forget?
- What would I think of a friend who forgot a name?
- What could I say to put people at ease?

- What tools could help, like name tags, notes, or photos?
- What does God say about me?
- Which gatherings are most comfortable?

Truth summary

> My value to others and to God does not depend on my memory. I can be honest, use helpful tools, and enjoy people. God has not forgotten me.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Pride
- Friendship
- Humility
- Anxiety/Worry

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Pride

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "If I forget things, people will think less of me"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"If I forget things, people will think less of me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do my close friends say when I forget?
- ☐ What would I think of a friend who forgot a name?
- ☐ What could I say to put people at ease?
- ☐ What tools could help, like name tags, notes, or photos?
- ☐ What does God say about me?
- ☐ Which gatherings are most comfortable?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God sees my heart.
- ☐ We carry one another's burdens.
- ☐ Weaker parts are indispensable.
- ☐ God has inscribed me on His hands.
- ☐ Honesty invites kindness.
- ☐ I can enjoy people.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ 1 Samuel 16:7
  "But the LORD said to Samuel, 'Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.'"
- ☐ Galatians 6:2
  "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."
- ☐ 1 Corinthians 12:22
  "On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable."

A verse I found myself: _____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ At ease with others: Each week, note one gathering you enjoyed.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 1 Samuel 16:7 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The Lord sees my heart, not my memory.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- ☐ Prepare a phrase. Try, "My memory is slower now, so please be patient."
- ☐ Use tools. Notes, photos, calendar.
- ☐ Choose settings. Pick calm gatherings.
- ☐ Pray Isaiah 49:16. Remember God does not forget you.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "If I forget things, people will think less of me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	At ease with others
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~If I forget things, people will think less of me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I forget and I am embarrassed. Thank You that You never forget me. Give me honest friends and ease with others. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.